> As for myself, I am prepared to consider your concerns seriously, even when I have difficulty understanding why they are held. I am willing to explore possible ways to alleviate them. But solutions will elude us if you are unable to approach our discussions in the same spirit, or if you demand concessions as an entry fee for the discussions themselves.

(This was a reference to Moscow's demands that we halt deployment of NATO's new INF missiles before it would return to Geneva.)

Perhaps, America's policies had been misunderstood in Moscow: Contrary to what Soviet leaders might believe, I wrote, the United States

> has no desire to threaten the security of the Soviet Union and its allies, nor are we seeking military superiority or to impose our will on others. . . .

Alluding to a remark by Chernenko that it was dangerous for either side to attempt to upset the prevailing balance of forces and gain a military advantage (a veiled reference to the INF missiles), I continued:

> I agree that such attempts are dangerous, but many actions of the Soviet Union in recent years would represent just such attempts. I do not intend to debate these matters in this letter because the United States views are well known; I feel we should move beyond mutual recrimination and attempts to assess blame and find concrete steps we can both take to put the relations on a more positive track. . . .

I wrote that all of us involved in arms control discussions must realize we had to hurdle a difficult practical stumbling